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The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, clouds giving way to sun, showers early, breezy, cooler, high 49. **Tonight**, clear, breezy, cooler. Low 32. **Tomorrow**, mostly sunny, high 47. Weather map is on Page D8.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



DIEGO IBARRA SANCHEZ FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Distributing wooden pallets to war-displaced people living out of tents in Beirut, Lebanon. The rain has made conditions harsher.

Flexing Power, Lewandowski Put D.H.S. on Edge

This article is by **Hamed Aleaziz, Alexandra Berzon, Nicholas Nehamas, Zolan Kanno-Youngs and Tyler Pager.**

WASHINGTON — Inside Kristi Noem’s spacious office on the second floor of the Department of Homeland Security’s headquarters, where a painting of the secretary astride a horse decorated the wall, Corey Lewandowski would hold court.

Over the last year, Ms. Noem’s top aide and confidant hosted meetings in the office without her present, grilling agency officials and issuing orders as he flexed his vast influence over President

Influence Over Agency Far Exceeded Role as Unpaid Noem Aide

Trump’s efforts to detain and deport millions of immigrants, people with knowledge of the sessions told The New York Times.

Presiding over gatherings in the secretary’s office was just one way Mr. Lewandowski exerted power far beyond the scope of his role as unpaid adviser. While he joined the department early last year in what was supposed to be a limited, part-time role, the long-

time Republican operative used his perch to build an expansive portfolio in which he had wide influence over personnel, contracts and the department’s operations on the ground, according to nearly 20 current and former administration officials, many of whom spoke on the condition of anonymity out of fear of retaliation.

Mr. Lewandowski helped elevate Gregory Bovino, a midlevel U.S. Border Patrol leader, to a senior position commanding militarized deportation raids across the United States, three people familiar with Mr. Lewandowski’s actions said.

He was among the top officials

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LEBANON DISPATCH

War Descends On Shorefront In Posh Beirut

By **ABDI LATIF DAHIR**

BEIRUT, Lebanon — The shirtless jogger, his headphones in and his back slick with sweat, ran past a row of tents pitched along the seafront in downtown Beirut, Lebanon’s capital. In one tent, a displaced family of four — uprooted by weeks of war that have convulsed the nation — watched him pass.

For a moment, the scene held its uneasy calm. The evening sun faded into the Mediterranean Sea, the steady rhythm of the waves softened the edges of the day, and the runner kept his pace, eyes forward. And then a deafening roar shattered it all: An Israeli airstrike had hit a nearby neighborhood, sending plumes of smoke into the sky.

“We chose the seaside because it is peaceful,” said Hussein Hame, 37, who, along with his wife and two children, was displaced this month from Dahiya, a collection of neighborhoods on the southern outskirts of Beirut where Hezbollah holds sway. “But this war finds you everywhere.”

War has returned to Lebanon, and the capital’s meandering seafront has become an unlikely front line. Here, a stark contrast has emerged: The displaced and destitute sit in the cold, while others live life as usual — jogging, cycling — amid the dizzying wealth and luxury that exist nearby.

In early March, Israel unleashed a barrage of attacks on Lebanon after the Iran-backed

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GABRIELA BHASKAR/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Flooding Ravages Hawaii
Days of intense rain caused the worst flooding in 20 years, forcing thousands on Oahu to evacuate.

Supreme Court Could Complicate Mail Voting in the Midterms

By **NICK CORASANITI**

A case about mail voting that will be the subject of oral arguments before the Supreme Court Monday in some ways boils down to a simple question. What is the definition of Election Day?

But the potential political consequences of the case, which was brought by allies of President Trump who want to bar states from counting mailed ballots that

arrive after Election Day, are far more tangible.

Coming smack in the middle of this year’s hotly contested battle for control of Congress, the case could upend election rules in at least 18 states and territories, potentially disqualifying hundreds of thousands of mail ballots in upcoming contests that would be considered valid under current law.

The case, *Watson v. Republican*

G.O.P. Pushes for an Election Day Cutoff

National Committee, stems from President Trump’s fixation with mail voting, and will test the effort of Mr. Trump and his allies to impose voting restrictions born out of his baseless claims of widespread fraud. There is scant evi-

dence, for instance, for his claim that accepting ballots postmarked by Election Day but received afterward invites a flood of phony votes that sway results.

Whether the law allows for states to establish such grace periods is a more convoluted legal question.

Federal statute establishes Election Day as the “Tuesday next after the 1st Monday in Novem-

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Israel Planned to Ignite Mass Uprising in Iran, But It Failed to Emerge

Trump Tempers Initial Embrace of Effort

This article is by **Mark Mazzetti, Julian E. Barnes, Edward Wong and Ronen Bergman.**

WASHINGTON — As the United States and Israel prepared to go to war with Iran, the head of Mossad, Israel’s foreign intelligence service, went to Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu with a plan.

Within days of the war’s beginning, said David Barnea, the Mossad chief, his service would likely be able to galvanize the Iranian opposition — igniting riots and other acts of rebellion that could even lead to the collapse of Iran’s government. Mr. Barnea also presented the proposal to senior Trump administration officials during a visit to Washington in mid-January.

Mr. Netanyahu adopted the plan. Despite doubts about its viability among senior American officials and some officials in other Israeli intelligence agencies, both he and President Trump seemed to embrace an optimistic outlook. Killing Iran’s leaders at the outset of the conflict, followed by a series of intelligence operations intended to encourage regime change, they thought, could lead to a mass uprising that might bring about a swift end to the war.

“Take over your government: It will be yours to take,” Mr. Trump told Iranians in his initial address at the war’s start, after saying they should first seek shelter from the bombing.

Three weeks into the war, an Iranian uprising has not yet materialized. American and Israeli intelligence assessments have concluded that the theocratic Iranian government is weakened but intact, and that widespread fear of Iran’s military and police forces

has dampened prospects both for nascent rebellion in the country and for ethnic militias outside of Iran to launch cross-border incursions.

The belief that Israel and the United States could help instigate widespread revolt was a foundational flaw in the preparations for a war that has spread across the Middle East. Instead of imploding, Iran’s government has dug in and escalated the conflict, striking blows and counterblows against military bases, cities, ships in the Persian Gulf and vulnerable oil and gas installations.

This account is based on interviews with more than a dozen current and former American, Israeli and other foreign officials, most of whom spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss national security and intelligence issues during a war. The New York Times interviewed officials with a variety of views on the likelihood of an uprising.

Since Mr. Trump’s first speech, American officials have largely abandoned speaking publicly about the prospects for revolt inside Iran, yet some remain hopeful that one could materialize. Though his language has become more tempered, Mr. Netanyahu still says the American and Israeli air campaign will be aided by forces on the ground.

“You can’t do revolutions from the air,” he said during a news conference on Thursday. He added: “There has to be a ground component as well. There are many possibilities for this ground component, and I take the liberty of not sharing with you all those possibilities.”

Mr. Netanyahu also added that

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ARASH KHAMOOSHI FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

The aftermath of an attack over the weekend in Tehran. Some in U.S. and Israeli intelligence doubted the likelihood of a rebellion.

Hits on Mideast Infrastructure Place World Economy in Peril

By **PATRICIA COHEN**

The game has changed. From the moment the United States and Israel attacked Iran, the nightmare scenario for the global economy that most people talked about was the closing of the Strait of Hormuz, the most important choke point for oil on the planet.

But a different and more disturbing nightmare began to unfold with direct attacks on the backbone of the Persian Gulf region’s energy production: the prospect of millions of dollars’ worth of long-term damage to facilities that supply a critical portion of the world’s natural gas.

Now, instead of wondering if the war would last for days or weeks, officials and economists are speculating about effects that could last for months and years.

“We have moved from stopping transit, which is a temporary

Natural Gas Production Not Easily Restarted

measure, to attacking infrastructure, which has long-term effects,” said David Goldwyn, a former U.S. diplomat and Energy Department official.

This new phase of the war began Wednesday, when Iran carried out a retaliatory missile strike on Ras Laffan, Qatar’s vast energy complex. That target produces roughly a fifth of the world’s liquefied natural gas, a transportable fuel used to heat homes, cook food, power factories and generate electricity throughout Asia and Europe.

Iran hit other refineries and gas facilities in Kuwait, Qatar and Saudi Arabia on Thursday. The strikes followed an Israeli attack

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No Oil Boom in Texas

Even with oil prices spiking, people in the Permian Basin do not expect a sudden surge in drilling jobs.

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Flooding Without an Easy Fix

A push to dredge a river in Washington reveals the conflicting interests of local officials, farmers and tribes.

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INTERNATIONAL A4-8

Changing Italy’s Constitution

Voting has started on a referendum to overhaul the judiciary. Many people don’t understand the complex proposal backed by the prime minister.

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Funding France’s Far Right

The billionaire Pierre-Édouard Stérin is financing projects and candidates to create a less Muslim, more Catholic and more capitalist nation.

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Healing a Belgian Community

Molenbeek was branded a hotbed of radicalization after terrorists hit Brussels and Paris a decade ago. Re-invention hasn’t come easy.

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British Artist’s Balancing Act

As a big retrospective of Hurvin Anderson’s work nears, he’s unsure how to feel about his achievements.

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Trouble in ‘Bachelor’ Empire

The ABC dating-show franchise finds itself mired in scandals and stymied by its traditional approach to love.

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BUSINESS B1-8

Big Tech Ditching the Grid

With the breakneck expansion of new data centers across the U.S., companies have a big need for electricity. Some are using machines like gas turbines to produce their own supply.

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Asia Gives Glimpse of Oil Crisis

As China and other major suppliers of refined oil in the region restrict exports, import-dependent countries are desperate to secure fuel supplies and scramble to keep flights running.

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Shira Efron

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SPORTS D1-8

Navigating a New Strike Zone

Some feared that automated calls would kill pitch framing. Instead, catchers are weaponizing it, learning hitters’ zones to use it against them.

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